

PSU fan using a PC vacuum. This will increase the working life of the PSU fan as well as the PSU itself. If the fan stops working, the PSU will generate heat and cause more trouble. So a little prevention will save you a lot of headaches later.

If the sound is not from the fan but from within the PSU itself, then you may be able to service it. A PSU has no ‘user-serviceable’ parts, and it’s best left to a competent technician, although in most cases of component failure, you will have to replace the PSU.

### 1.3.7 The PC freezes or reboots suddenly

1. This could indicate a failing PSU that is not supplying power correctly to the motherboard. You may be able to get the PSU serviced but in most cases you will be better off getting a new power supply.
2. This could be due to overheating of the PSU or CPU: If the PSU is overheating, the metal cabinet may be hot to touch or you might get a shock. Shut off immediately. Check if the PSU fan is working, clean or replace the fan if not working or spinning very slowly. If it’s a faulty PSU you may be able to service it.

If the PSU seems normal it might be due to an overheating CPU.

## 1.4 Troubleshooting Motherboards

Problems with motherboards are rare. It gets blamed for problems caused by other hardware such as add-on cards. However, you cannot eliminate the motherboard from your list of suspects till you’ve investigated further. It’s a good idea to leave troubleshooting the motherboard for the end, unless, of course, there is some visible sign like scorch marks or a burnt smell coming from the motherboard. The bad news is there is little you can repair on the motherboard. So, keep your fingers crossed when working with it, and hopefully you won’t have to shell out big bucks to replace it. And not to forget the standard warning: *Don’t work on or touch the motherboard with the power*